CROSS-BORDER NOTES

A bank compliance team in Amman cut me off mid-pitch. They didn't want the impact story. They wanted to know if my climate data would get them closer to their green lending quota.

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Sustainability teams write the narrative. They do not sign the purchase order.

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Compliance teams own the quota. Missing it triggers a regulatory penalty, not a bad headline.

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Local banks buy climate data because the cost of non-compliance is priced and dated. Goodwill is not.

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The pull is not an impact thesis. It is a regulatory deadline on the buyer's desk, and proof is needed before that date.

Reading ESG pitch decks to size demand? Read the mandate instead. Find out who gets penalized, and by when.

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